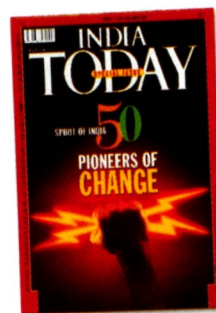


SANJAY RAMACHANDRAN



"Spirit of India",
July 7, 2008

"These 50 pioneers cemented our faith in the humane spirit with inspiring stories of ordinary people making extraordinary difference in others' lives."

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*



Service Before Self

Kudos to INDIA TODAY for highlighting the achievements of the lesser known mortals who have dedicated their lives to the betterment of the society ("Spirit of India: 50 Pioneers of Change", July 7). These unsung heroes need recognition and support for their humble causes. Their path-breaking innovations and movements have benefited many people and changed many lives. Hats off to such pioneers of change, the true spirit of India.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

It is indeed a quirk of fate that even after 60 years of India's Independence, 75 per cent of 1.1 billion of its population live on less than Rs 80 a day, and about 50 per cent children have never been to school, where 1.2 million under the age of five die of malnutrition every year and a

majority of population doesn't have access to safe drinking water, proper sanitation and healthcare. Are we still proud of the 'spirit of India'?

VITULL K. GUPTA, *on e-mail*

Your cover story dedicated to the crusaders of change is absolutely motivating. These people and their success stories will inspire countless to follow in their footsteps and make life more meaningful, both for themselves and for others.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
on e-mail

Our former President A.P.J. Abdul Kalam ("The Great Need: A Transformation in Thinking", July 7) had a dream for "we, the people", which sadly remained unfulfilled. How can a nation that cannot provide quality basic education for its children, that cannot supply sufficient power at affordable prices,

that is unable to make clean drinking water available to its people and that cannot give basic medical aids to the needy even after 60 years of Independence bring about transformation? To transform a society, an honest implementation agency is needed, which unfortunately India doesn't have. But it does have politicians who can manipulate and make things work the way they want to, not the way it should be. For them, it is self before service.

V.K. NAIR, *Mumbai*

Your wonderful issue on harbingers of change was an issue of hope. It was indeed a glowing tribute to those unknown faces, who, through their pioneering efforts, are making lives of millions of Indians easier. Such commendable success stories will certainly bring in a positive change in the mindset of the people.

K.B. AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Soaring Price

The rising prices have brought in unforeseen turbulence for the Government ("The Big Squeeze", June 30). Only time will tell if the captain of the UPA's ship, Manmohan Singh, and his navigator Sonia Gandhi, are able to wake up and steer the Government carefully away from such trouble so that the common man doesn't drown in inflation. Rich get richer and it is the poor who end up paying through their nose.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

The prices of essential commodities are slowly and steadily going out of the common man's reach. It is time our policymakers and political leaders evolved strategies to bring the common man's sufferings to an end.

BIDYUT KUMAR CHATTERJEE,
on e-mail